



DART

Direct mail targeting

Finding the right businesses to mail

A practical guide to building B2B flyer campaigns in DART — from a category search to a print-ready area list.

What this tool does	Picks the postal areas your flyer should land in, based on the businesses actually in them
Who it's for	Media Account Consultants, Direct Mail Experts and Managers
Data behind it	1,478,832 Canadian businesses; 1,643 postal areas

What this tool is for

You are selling a flyer drop to a business — a dental wholesaler, a farm parts dealer, a commercial laundry. That client does not want to mail houses. They want their flyer in the hands of **other businesses**, and only the right ones.

The hard part has always been answering a simple question: **if we mail this area, how many of the client's actual prospects are in it?** DART answers that by holding two things side by side on one map — every business in Canada, and the postal areas mail is sold by.

So the pitch stops being “this area has 12,000 addresses” and becomes “this area has 340 dental clinics.” That is a different conversation.

Businesses and farms only. DART deliberately leaves out houses and apartments. Every count you see is commercial — that is the whole point of a B2B drop. Farms are counted separately because agricultural clients care about them specifically.

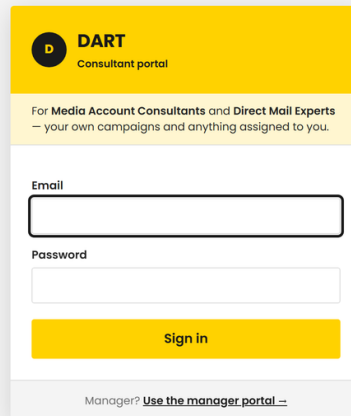
The three things it puts together

Businesses	1.48 million Canadian businesses with a street address, searchable by category — dentists, restaurants, farms, 1,944 categories in all
Postal areas	1,643 Forward Sortation Areas — the first three characters of a postal code, e.g. M5G — each with its own business and farm count
Campaigns	A saved selection of areas with a client, a date, a stage, artwork and a team conversation attached

Two ways in

There are two sign-in pages, and which one you use depends on your role.

/login.html	Media Account Consultants, Direct Mail Experts	Their own campaigns, plus any assigned to them
/manager.html	Managers	Every campaign in the team, every client, and team management



The image shows a login interface for the DART Consultant portal. At the top, there is a yellow header with a black circle containing a white 'D' logo, followed by the text 'DART' and 'Consultant portal' in a smaller font. Below this, a light yellow banner contains the text 'For Media Account Consultants and Direct Mail Experts' and '— your own campaigns and anything assigned to you.' The main form area is white and contains two input fields: 'Email' and 'Password'. Below these fields is a yellow 'Sign in' button. At the bottom of the form, there is a link that says 'Manager? [Use the manager portal —](#)'.

The consultant portal. Managers use a separate one.

Tutorial: a flyer drop for a dental wholesaler

We will build the campaign that ships with the tool as an example: **Northgate Dental Supply** sells chairside consumables and wants a flyer in front of dental clinics across the Greater Toronto Area.

The logic runs backwards from the client's customer. Their customer is a dental clinic. So we find the dental clinics, see which postal areas they cluster in, and mail those areas — rather than guessing at a radius.

Step 1 — Open a new campaign

From the Campaigns screen, choose **+ Create a new Campaign**. The first thing it asks for is the in-home date: the day the flyer should land. Set it and save.


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Campaigns

[+ Create a new Campaign](#)

Id	Title	Client	Stage	Assigned to	Effective date	Businesses	Farms	Total	Owner	Modified		
3	Q4 chairside consumables drop	Northgate Dental Supply	design	Selina Wong Production	Oct 15, 2026	8,840	12	9,852	mplante@local	Sep 20, 2026	Open	Delete
4	Spring parts catalogue — SK farms	Prairie AgriParts	approved	Selina Wong Production	Nov 2, 2026	2,180	406	2,586	mplante@local	Sep 20, 2026	Open	Delete
5	Hospitality prospecting — Metro Van	Coastal Linen Services	proposed	Selina Wong Production	Nov 20, 2026	6,420	3	6,423	mplante@local	Sep 20, 2026	Open	Delete

Showing 1 – 3 of 3 items.

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Every campaign you own or have been assigned, with its stage and counts.

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Direct mail targeting

Campaigns Clients Marc Plante Sales Sign out

Create or edit a Campaign

+ 0 Farms 0 blz. 0 Areas 0 Found 0

Choose a date for the campaign

19-Sep-2026

Cancel Save

Business lookup

Region
Choose a region...

Search by radius
City or town
5 km radius
[Reset all](#) Search

Choose a filter
All areas

No areas selected.
Pick a region, search by radius, or click the map.

Title
Campaign title

Stage
draft

Assigned to
— unassigned —

Client
— no client linked —

Account phone
(000) 000-0000

Creating a campaign starts by setting the in-home date.

Step 2 — Find the client's prospects

Switch the right-hand panel to **Business lookup**. This is the What and Where pair, the same shape as a directory search:

- **What** — the category your client sells to. Type “Dentists”. It autocompletes against all 1,944 categories.
- **Where** — a city, a province, or a wider area. Type “Greater Toronto Area” and pick it from the list.

Press **Search**. Every matching business appears as a pin on the map and a row in the list, ordered A→Z, each tagged with the postal area it sits in.

+

mi

0

Farms

0

biz.

0

Areas

0

Found

4,176

Areas

Business lookup

What

Dentists

Where

Greater Toronto Area (GTA)

Use map view

Search

4,176 dentists in Greater Toronto Area (GTA) · showing 1,200 · across 188 postal areas · A–Z

4U Dental Care

446 Hollandview Trl, Aurora

L46 general dentistry +19057261800

5 Points Dental Office

1177 Ritson Rd N, Oshawa

L1G dentist +19055714005

9th Line Dental

3945 Doug Leavens Blvd, Mississauga

L5N general dentistry +19057853900

Add 188 postal areas to campaign

Title

Campaign title

Stage

draft

Assigned to

— unassigned —

Client

— no client linked —

Account phone

(000) 000-0000

Business lookup: a What and a Where, results A→Z with their postal area.

Step 3 — Turn prospects into mailable areas

Read the summary line above the results. It says something like:

4,176 dentists in Greater Toronto Area (GTA) · showing 1,200 · across **189** postal areas · A→Z

That is the whole insight in one sentence. Those 4,176 clinics are not spread evenly — they sit in 189 specific postal areas, and some of those areas hold far more than others.

Underneath it is a button: **Add 189 postal areas to campaign**. Press it and every area containing a prospect joins your selection.

Areas

Business lookup

What

Dentists

Where

Greater Toronto Area (GTA)

[Use map view](#)

Search

4,176 dentists in Greater Toronto Area (GTA) · showing 1,200 · across 188 postal areas · A→Z

4U Dental Care

446 Hollandview Trl, Aurora

L4G

 general dentistry +19057261800

5 Points Dental Office

1177 Ritson Rd N, Oshawa

L1G

 dentist +19055714005

9th Line Dental

3945 Doug Leavens Blvd, Mississauga

L5N

 general dentistry +19057853900

Add 188 postal areas to campaign

The summary line converts a business search into a list of postal areas.

The totals come from the **full** result set, not just the 1,200 rows loaded into the list. Adding 189 areas reflects all 4,176 dentists.

Step 4 — Trim the selection

189 areas is usually too many to mail. Switch to the **Areas** tab, where each selected area is listed with its own counts, and cut it down:

- Click any area on the map to drop it from the selection, or use the × in the list.
- Click a row to zoom the map to that area's boundary.
- Use **Search by radius** to keep only what is near a chosen city.
- Watch the chips above the map — **Total**, **Farms**, **biz.** and **Areas** update on every change.

Those chips are what you quote to the client. When the business count matches the budget, the selection is done.

D

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Campaigns
Clients
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Create or edit a Campaign

+

bl

263,150

Farms

712

biz.

262,438

Areas

189

Found

4,176

Areas

Business lookup

Region

Choose a region...

Search by radius

City or town

5 km radius

Reset all

Search

Choose a filter

All areas

K9V	Ontario	1,252 biz · 25 farms	✕
LOE	Ontario	441 biz · 14 farms	✕
LOG	Ontario	1,127 biz · 46 farms	✕
LOJ	Ontario	167 biz · 0 farms	✕
LOM	Ontario	853 biz · 32 farms	✕
LIC	Ontario	1,385 biz · 12 farms	✕

Title

Campaign title

Stage

draft

Assigned to

— unassigned —

Client

— no client linked —

Account phone

(000) 000-0000

Selected areas fill yellow. The chips total businesses and farms live.

Step 5 — Name it, link the client, save

Below the map, give the campaign a title, pick the **Client** from the dropdown, set the **Stage**, and assign it to whoever picks it up next. Press **Save**.

Title	What the drop is, e.g. “Q4 chairside consumables drop”
Client	Links the campaign to a client record, so it appears on their page
Stage	draft → proposed → approved → design → print → mailed → closed
Assigned to	Hands it to a teammate — they immediately gain access to it

A second example: targeting farms

Prairie AgriParts sells tractor parts in Saskatchewan. Their customer is a working farm, and a normal business count tells them nothing useful — a postal area full of offices is worthless to them.

This is why farms are counted separately everywhere in the tool.

How to build it

- In **Business lookup**, search What = “Farms”, Where = “Saskatchewan”.
- Or work from the map: on the **Areas** tab set the filter to **Farms only focus (10+ farms)**, which greys out every area without meaningful agricultural presence.
- Select the areas that remain and read the **Farms** chip.

The seeded example lands on 4 postal areas holding **406 farms** alongside 2,180 other businesses. The client's number is the 406.

Areas

Business lookup

Region

Choose a region... ▾

Search by radius

City or town

5 km radius

[Reset all](#)

Search

Choose a filter

Farms only focus (10+ farms) ▾

K9V	Ontario	1,252 biz · 25 farms	✕
L0E	Ontario	441 biz · 14 farms	✕
L0G	Ontario	1,127 biz · 46 farms	✕
L0J	Ontario	167 biz · 0 farms	✕
L0M	Ontario	853 biz · 32 farms	✕
L1C	Ontario	1,385 biz · 12 farms	✕

Regions and the farm filter for agricultural targeting.

Rural postal areas have a **0** as their second character — S0K, K0K, J0B. If your farm selection is full of them, that is a good sign you are in the right place.

Picking areas by region

The **Region** dropdown selects whole metro areas in one action — 26 of them, including the GTA, Lower Mainland, Greater Montreal, Calgary Region and the National Capital Region. Useful when a client says “all of the GTA” and you want the full footprint before trimming.

Handing the work between teams

A flyer campaign passes through several hands. Once a campaign is saved, two panels appear beneath it that carry it the rest of the way.

Design

Each artwork round is added as a version — v1, v2 — with a link to the proof and a status you can change inline: **draft**, **in review**, **approved**, **sent to print**. Everyone on the campaign sees the current state, so nobody mails a proof that was never signed off.

Team thread

A conversation attached to the campaign itself, not scattered across email. Each message can be addressed to one team — Sales, Design, Production, Management — or to everyone, and shows the sender's team beside their name.

Design versions and the team thread on a saved campaign.

Assigning gives access. A consultant cannot see a campaign that is not theirs. The moment it is assigned to them it appears in their list. That is how work moves between teams without opening everything to everyone.

The client record

Every client has a page holding their details, their contacts, every campaign run for them, and a timeline of calls, emails, meetings, tasks and notes. Tasks carry a due date and can be ticked off.

Before a renewal call, this page is the whole history in one place: what you mailed, where, how many businesses it reached, and what was said.

← All clients

 Save details

Campaigns [+ New campaign](#)

Q4 chairside consumables drop

design · Oct 15, 2026 · [mplant@local](#)

9,840 biz **12 farms** **Open**

Activity

call

▼

Subject

dd-----yyyy

📅

Log

Nothing logged yet.

For managers

Signing in through `/manager.html` shows every campaign in the team rather than just your own, with an Owner column and the stage of each.

D

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Campaigns

Clients

Team

Master

Sales

MANAGER

Sign out

Campaigns

Search campaigns...

+ Create a new Campaign

Id	Title	Client	Stage	Assigned to	Effective date	Businesses	Farms	Total	Owner	Modified		
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The manager portal sees every campaign across the team.

Managing the team

The **Team** screen — visible only to managers — creates accounts. Each person gets a role and a team:

Manager	/manager.html	Every campaign, every client, team management
Media Account Consultant	/login.html	Own campaigns and assigned ones
Direct Mail Expert	/login.html	Own campaigns and assigned ones

The team — Sales, Design, Production or Management — is separate from the role. It decides who a thread message reaches, not what someone can see.

Reading the pipeline

Stage colour on the campaigns list gives you the state of the book at a glance: grey while it is still being planned, yellow once it is in flight, black when it has been mailed or closed.

Where the numbers come from

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Overture Maps	1,478,832 Canadian businesses with addresses, categories, phone numbers	CDLA-Permissive 2.0
Statistics Canada	1,643 FSA boundaries from the 2021 Census	Statistics Canada Open Licence
OpenStreetMap	Base map tiles	ODbL

One limit worth knowing. DART works at postal-area (FSA) level, not Canada Post letter-carrier route level. An FSA is a district; a route is a single walk of a few hundred addresses. Use these counts to choose and pitch the target areas — then confirm the exact route selection and final price with Canada Post before the drop is booked.

Duplicate listings are merged automatically: the same business recorded twice under slightly different spellings or addresses is collapsed into one, keeping whichever record has the phone number and website. Counts you quote are of real distinct businesses.